

PUSH CHESS

Illustrated Ruleset : a strategic chess variant for 2 players- 15 – 30 min

OBJECT OF THE GAME

Checkmate your opponent's king - exactly as in standard chess. Push Chess adds one new action and one bonus square; everything else is the chess you already know.

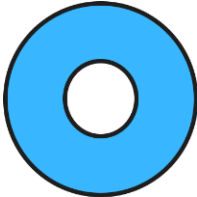
WHAT YOU NEED

Components

A standard chess set (8x8 board + 32 pieces) · one six-sided dice (1d6) · one bonus-square marker (a chip or token). Only the bishops are modified — and only visually, so you can tell them apart at a glance. Every other piece moves and captures exactly as in standard chess.



Push-bishop: collar + flat octagonal head signal it can push (8 directions).



Bonus-square marker — a chip placed where the dice point.

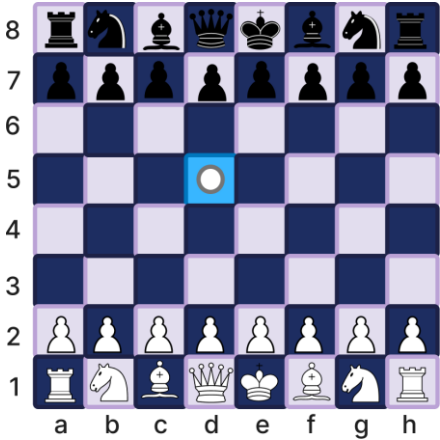


One d6 — both players roll once at setup.

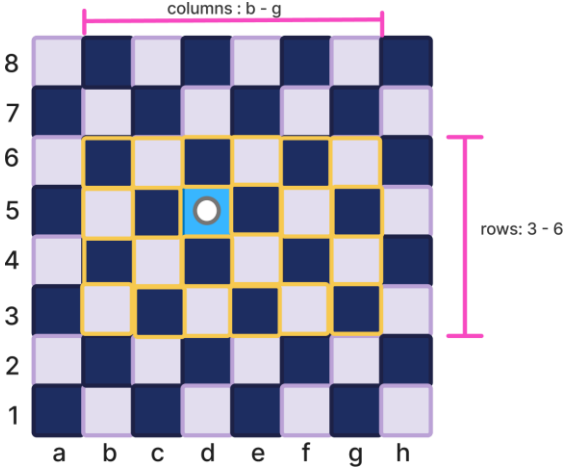
BEFORE THE FIRST MOVE

Setup

- 1 Place the bonus square first. — Each player rolls the dice once to choose central square (see the panel), and put the marker on it.
- 2 Set up the pieces normally. — Standard chess starting position. The marker stays visible on its square all game.
- 3 White moves first.



Starting position with the bonus square marked (here, d5).



columns : b - g

rows: 3 - 6

Dice place the marker only in the shaded central band (files b–g, ranks 3–6).

How the dice choose the square:

Die result	1 2	3 4	5 6
Player 1 Die → file (column)	b c	d e	f g
Player 2 Die → rank (row)	re-roll	3 4	5 6

2 Die rolls land on a fair central square — re-roll when die 2 for rank results in 1 or 2. (Edges are skipped: bishops reach corners poorly and home ranks start occupied.)

ON YOUR TURN

How to Play

Take one action, then your opponent takes theirs — just like chess:

- A Move one piece — following normal chess rules (movement, captures, check, castling, en passant, promotion).
- B If a bishop just landed on the bonus square, — bishop side may immediately make ONE push as part of that same turn (see The Push, below). The push is a free bonus action; it never replaces your normal move.

THE ONE NEW ACTION — WHAT MAKES THIS NOT JUST CHESS